



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

buddhi+indriya+prāṇa+guṇair viyuktaḥ |
supto* vi+saṃjñas* trṇa+kāṣṭha+bhūtaḥ |
(saṃvardhya Csaṃbadhya)saṃrakṣya ca yatnavadbhiḥ |
(priya+priyais* Cpriya+a+priyais*)tyajyatae* eṣa* ko* *api | |3.57|*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Buddhacarita paints a stark picture of the body after death, stripped of its vital functions. It speaks of being devoid of the faculties of intellect (buddhi), senses (indriya), and life force (prāṇa), reduced to the state of mere wood and straw, unconscious (visaṃjñas) and inert. Though once carefully nurtured, protected with great effort and surrounded by loved ones, the body is ultimately abandoned. It asks, "This body, who is it really, that is discarded?"

The core message transcends a simple observation of mortality. It delves into the nature of attachment and the illusion of self. We cling so fiercely to our physical form, identifying it as "us," pouring energy into its maintenance and adornment. Yet, the verse reminds us that this form is impermanent. It is a vessel that houses our consciousness, but it is not the consciousness itself. The "who" that is abandoned is not the true essence of being, the potential for enlightenment within.

In modern life, we are bombarded with messages reinforcing the importance of physical appearance and material possessions. This verse serves as a powerful antidote, urging us to look beyond the superficial. It encourages us to cultivate inner qualities like compassion, wisdom, and equanimity, which are not subject to decay and abandonment. By recognizing the impermanence of the body, you can begin to detach from your identification with it, freeing yourself from the anxieties and fears associated with aging and death. You can invest your energy in developing a deeper sense of self, one that is rooted in your spiritual nature rather than your physical form. This understanding allows you to live with greater purpose and meaning, focusing on what truly matters: cultivating inner peace and contributing to the well-being of others.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you begin to loosen your grip on your physical identity today and connect more deeply with your inner self?